

FAQs

Formatting hard disks

Q Does formatting hard disks regularly harm it in any way?

Abhinav Asija

Via e-mail

A There is no documented evidence that regular formatting of hard disks causes any sort of damage to it. However, we would not recommend it.

Virus problem

Q Recently, as I was scanning my hard disk using Norton Antivirus 2001, it detected a virus called JS.Exception.Exploit. As Norton failed to repair it, I sent it to quarantine. Will it affect my system files if I delete it from the quarantined items?

Siby

Via e-mail

A When a machine is infected with a virus it is not necessary that the anti-virus program will be able to recover the infected file as that depends upon the extent of damage caused. Hence, when the anti-virus detects a file that is infected it first tries to repair the file and if it can't, it will quarantine the file, as it did in your case. Once the file is quarantined it means the file has been isolated and it can no longer spread the infection to other files. Deleting a quarantined file might cause problems if it is a

system file. Hence, it'd be better to leave quarantined files as they are.

HDD error

Q I clean formatted my hard disk and installed Windows 98 SE. After that, when I started my machine, it loaded Windows. But when I try to open a program, a blue screen appears saying 'Disk Write Error'. When I boot after this, an automatic surface scan begins but after some time it again gives this error and I am forced to reboot. Please help.

Sandhya

Via e-mail

A It appears your hard disk has developed bad sectors as a result of which you are experiencing this problem. We advise you to take a backup of your data on a different media and then try running a utility called DFT from the official Web site of IBM, www.ibm.com. This will analyse your hard disk and give you a report as to whether your hard disk is in good condition or not. If your hard disk has developed bad sectors, the DFT utility will try recovering them.

If it can't be recovered then you can give it to the RMA centre for repairs or ask the dealer for other options if you have a warranty.

Assigning folder passwords

Q I have a folder in my office computer, which contains several confidential files. How can I prevent an unauthorised person from gaining access to this folder? Can I

assign a password to this folder so that only those who know this password can open it?

Malhotra

Via e-mail

A You can prevent others from accessing your confidential folder by following any of the two methods. The first is to use a third party encrypting utility, which allows you to set a password. But a better method is to use a utility, which can hide the selected folders so that no one except you would be aware of those folders. You can use a software called Magic Folders, available at <http://www.pc-magic.com>, to hide your folders. You will have to enter a password to gain access. Alternatively, you can install a software called Secure IT 2000, manufactured by Secure IT (www.secure-soft.com), which gives you a 448-bit level encryption.

Creating PDF files from Office XP

Q I recently installed Adobe Acrobat PDF Writer (version 5) and upgraded from Office 2000 to Office XP. I remember when I had installed Office 2000, I could create PDF files from my Word or Excel documents from the Office program itself. I can't do so now. I tried doing it manually from Acrobat Distiller but it keeps generating

errors. Please help.

Sandip

Via e-mail

A You are unable to create PDF files from the Office document because you have not installed the patch that has been exclusively released by Adobe to fix this problem. You can download the patch from <http://www.adobe.com/support/downloads/detail.jsp?ftplD=1309>. Install the patch and you should not face any troubles anymore.

Running 3D Studio Max 4 on Windows XP

Q I installed 3D Studio Max 4 and it was working fine on Windows 2000. I later upgraded my system to Windows XP, after which whenever I try to open the program it generates errors and says failed to C-dilla. I then tried running the program through the 'Program Compatibility Mode' but the result is the same. How do I get the program running in Windows XP?

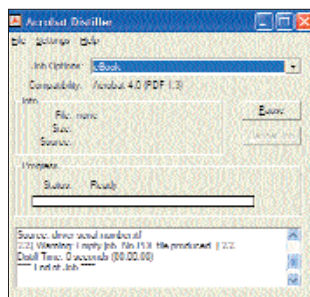
Anand Mishra

Via e-mail



3D Max can't run in Windows XP

A You are getting this error because Windows XP recognises this software as an extremely old one and hence it gives errors while initialising the program. In order to make the program run you should go to www.macrovision.com and download a program that can make 3D Studio Max run in Windows XP.



Adobe Distiller refuses to create PDF files



Send your problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write in to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706



Hide your folders from other users